

ENGLISH LANGUAGE

MODERN ENGLISH (891)

PAPER 1 (Theory)

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: Three Hours

Reading Time: Additional Fifteen Minutes

Instructions to Candidates

1. You are allowed an additional **fifteen minutes** for **only** reading the question paper.
2. You must **NOT** start writing during reading time.
3. This question paper has 5 printed pages.
4. It has **four** questions in all.
5. Answer **all** questions.
6. You are advised to spend not more than 45 minutes on Question 1, 55 minutes on Question 2, 30 minutes on Question 3 and 50 minutes on Question 4.
7. While answering Multiple Choice Questions in Question 4, you are required to write only **one** option as the answer.
8. You should begin each answer on a fresh page.
9. The intended marks for questions are given in brackets [].

Instruction to Supervising Examiner

1. Kindly read aloud the Instructions given on page 1 to all the candidates present in the examination hall.

Question 1

Write a composition (in approximately 400 – 450 words) on any one of the following subjects. [20]

(You are reminded that you will be rewarded for the orderly and coherent presentation of the matter, use of appropriate style and general accuracy of spelling, punctuation and grammar.)

- (i) You went with your uncle to the wholesale flower market by the river before sunrise. Describe the sights, the sounds and the smells of the market as it came to life, and the people you watched at work. Say what the morning taught you about the way people earn their living.
- (ii) Your class was to present the morning assembly, and at the last minute you were asked to speak on stage in place of a friend who had fallen ill. Narrate what happened and how you overcame your fear.
- (iii) Zoos should be closed down. Argue either FOR or AGAINST the given statement.
- (iv) Time
- (v) 'Simple living, high thinking.' Present your reflections on this statement.
- (vi) Write an original short story that ends with the following words:
... It was then that he understood why his grandfather had never sold the watch.

Question 2

- (i) You write a blog about the history and everyday life of your city. Last Sunday you joined a guided heritage walk through its oldest quarter. Write a blog post in about 250 – 300 words, based on the following guidelines: [15]
- the title of your post and the date – the route of the walk and the landmarks you saw – a story told by the guide – the local food you tried on the way – the condition of the old buildings – your appeal to readers
- (ii) As the Secretary of the Eco Club of your school, you wish to make the school campus free of single-use plastic and to set up a composting unit for the waste from the canteen and the gardens. Write a proposal in not more than 150 words, stating the steps you would take to make it a success. [10]

Question 3

Answer subparts (i), (ii) and (iii).

- (i) Rewrite the following sentences according to the instructions given after each of them in brackets. [5]
- (a) As soon as the referee blew the final whistle, the fans rushed onto the field.
(Begin: No sooner ...)
- (b) The village council will repair the old well before the monsoon.
(End: ... by the village council.)
- (c) Meera locked the shop and went home.
(Begin: Having ...)
- (d) She saved money every month in order to buy a bicycle for her brother.
(Use: so that)
- (e) The coach said to the players, “Rest well tonight because tomorrow’s match is important.”
(Begin: The coach advised ...)
- (ii) In the following sentences, replace the INCORRECT underlined words to make the sentences meaningful and grammatically correct. Do not copy the sentences. [5]
- (a) Grandmother asked me to look into my little sister while she was at the market.
- (b) The police promised to look after the complaint without delay.
- (c) Despite the power failure, the surgeons carried off with the operation.
- (d) The engineers carried up a careful survey of the bridge before opening it.
- (e) The two friends quarrelled in the morning but made out before lunch.
- (f) In the dim light I could barely make up the words on the signboard.
- (g) After a long argument, the shopkeeper finally gave out and lowered the price.
- (h) The volunteers gave up leaflets to everyone who passed the gate.
- (i) Her bright red coat made her stand off in the grey crowd.
- (j) A true friend will stand out you when times are hard.

- (iii) Fill in the blanks in the passage given below with the appropriate form of the verb given in brackets. Do not write the passage but write the verbs in the correct order. [5]

Long ago, a poor farmer named Ramu _____ (1) (borrow) a small sum from the village moneylender to buy seed. The harvest failed that year, and the next, and each time the moneylender _____ (2) (add) more interest to the debt. Soon Ramu owed so much that he could not even hope to _____ (3) (repay) it.

One morning the moneylender _____ (4) (arrive) at the field, _____ (5) (wave) a paper in his hand. "This land _____ (6) (belong) to me from today," he declared, "unless you can answer my riddle." Ramu, who _____ (7) (hear) of the man's riddles before, agreed at once. "What grows bigger the more you take away from it?" asked the moneylender. Without _____ (8) (hesitate), Ramu replied, "A hole in the ground, sir, like the one your interest has made in my purse." The villagers laughed so loudly that the moneylender _____ (9) (tear) up the paper and hurried away. He was never _____ (10) (see) in that village again.

Question 4

Read the passage given below and answer the questions (i), (ii) and (iii) that follow.

- (1) Tara joined our class in the middle of the monsoon term, when friendships had long been settled and every desk already had its owner. She came from a tea garden high in the hills, where her father had been the doctor, and on her first morning she stood at the door of Class Seven with a brass tiffin-box in one hand and a cloth bag in the other, waiting for someone to tell her where to sit. 5
- (2) Nobody did. Mrs Sen, our class teacher, was busy with the register, and the rest of us were busy staring. At last Tara walked to the empty bench at the back, beside the broken window that let in the rain, and sat down as though it were the best seat in the room.
- (3) It was Anish who began it. Anish was our monitor, clever and quick-tongued, and whatever he laughed at, the class laughed at too. He laughed at the way Tara rolled her r's, and above all at the tiffin-box, which rattled like a temple bell whenever she opened it. Before long he had given her a name, 'Tiffin-Tara', and the name stuck. I am ashamed to say that I used it as well. It was easier to laugh with Anish than to be laughed at by him. 10
- (4) What puzzled us was that Tara never seemed to mind. She did not complain to Mrs Sen, she did not cry in the washroom, and she did not try to buy our friendship with sweets. She simply smiled and went on reading the thick, dog-eared books she carried in her cloth bag. Her calm took the wind out of Anish's sails, and I think it annoyed him more than tears would have done. 15
- (5) In December the school took us on a nature trail in the forest reserve outside the town. Our teachers led us up a narrow path through the sal trees. Anish, as usual, marched at the head of the line, determined to be the first to reach the watch-tower at the top. 20
- (6) He never reached it. Halfway up, trying to leap across a stream instead of using the stepping-stones, he slipped on a wet rock and fell awkwardly. When we caught up with him, he was sitting in the mud, clutching his ankle, and his lunch-box lay open in the water, his sandwiches floating away like little rafts. 25
- (7) For a moment nobody knew what to do. The teachers were far behind with the slower children, and those of us who had laughed loudest with Anish now stood round him in silence. It was Tara who pushed through. She knelt beside him, felt the ankle gently with both hands and told him firmly to keep still. Then she soaked her long scarf in the cold 30

stream and bound the ankle tightly, the way, she said, her father had taught the tea-pickers to do when someone twisted a foot on the slopes.

- (8) 'It is a sprain, not a break,' she said. 'You must not walk on it until a doctor has seen it.' She spoke with such quiet authority that even Anish obeyed.
- (9) While a stretcher was sent for, we all sat down to wait. Anish had nothing to eat, and he was trying hard not to look at anybody. Tara opened the famous brass tiffin-box. Inside were four soft rotis rolled round spiced potatoes. Without a word, she held out two of them to him. 35
- (10) I shall never forget his face. He looked at the rotis, then at the box he had mocked for three months, and then at Tara. 'Why are you doing this?' he asked in a low voice. 'After everything I said?' Tara only shrugged. 'You were hungry,' she said. 'And my mother always packs too much.' 40
- (11) Something changed in our class after that trip, though nobody announced it. The name was never used again. Anish, limping on a bandaged foot for a fortnight, made a point of carrying her books up the stairs. The rest of us followed him, as we always had. By spring the bench beside the broken window had become the most crowded seat in the room. 45
- (12) We had taken Tara's silence for weakness, when it was a kind of strength that none of us possessed. She had not answered cruelty with cruelty; she had waited, and when the moment came, she had chosen kindness.

(An original passage written for this sample paper)

- (i)(a) Find a single word from the passage that will exactly replace the underlined word or words in the following sentences. [3]

- (1) The villagers made fun of the young inventor until his machine actually worked.
- (2) The general expected every soldier to do what he was told without question.
- (3) The results of the election were made known publicly at noon.

- (i)(b) For each of the words given below, choose the correct sentence that uses the same word unchanged in spelling, but with a different meaning from that which it carries in the passage. [3]

- (1) **register** (line 6)

- (A) The clerk wrote the names of all the visitors in the register.
- (B) The warning did not register with him until the train had already left.
- (C) The teacher marked me absent in the attendance register.
- (D) He sent the documents by registered post.

- (2) **bench** (line 7)

- (A) The judge's remarks from the bench surprised both the lawyers.
- (B) We sat on a park bench to eat our sandwiches.
- (C) The carpenter's workbench was covered in sawdust.
- (D) The old wooden bench creaked under his weight.

- (3) **trail** (line 20)

- (A) The mountain trail was closed to walkers after the landslide.
- (B) A narrow trail wound down the hillside to the lake.
- (C) The car's trailer was loaded with firewood.
- (D) Our team continued to trail the leaders by two points.

- (ii) Answer the following questions as briefly as possible in your own words.
- (a) Why do you think Tara never complained about the way she was treated? [2]
- (b) With reference to the passage, explain the meaning of the expression ‘took the wind out of Anish’s sails’. [2]
- (c) Why did the narrator also use the nickname ‘Tiffin-Tara’? [2]
- (iii) Summarise why the class, which had mocked Tara, came to respect her (paragraphs 6 to 11). [8]
You are required to write the summary in the grid form in about 100 words. The use of abbreviations and contractions will not be accepted. Failure to keep within the word limit will be penalised.

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